

FREE TRADE

INDIA PUSHES THE PEDAL ON TRADE

With a tariff war initiated by the US, India has stepped up efforts to conclude long pending trade pacts with the UK and the EU. Will 2025 be the year that they materialise?

BY SURABHI

► **WITH THE THREAT** of a global tariff war now fast becoming a full-fledged reality, India's long pending free trade agreement (FTA) talks seem to have been put on the fast track. What's significant is that

the partner countries seem equally keen on clinching a deal.

This sense of urgency was reflected in the talks that India held in the end of February with both the UK and the EU (negotiations have

been on since 2007 with the EU). India and New Zealand have also decided to restart FTA talks after a pause of 10 years.

India and the UK announced the resumption of FTA negotiations

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TRADE GAINS EU Chief Ursula von der Leyen and EU College of Commissioners with PM Narendra Modi, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar, Minister of Commerce Piyush Goyal, and other ministers